

PSY502 - Lesson 19

Behaviorism

Founder: John B. Watson (1878–1958)

1. Who was J.B. Watson?

J.B. Watson was an American psychologist who started the school of psychology called **Behaviorism**. He believed psychology should study **what people and animals do (behavior)** instead of what they *feel* or *think inside their mind*.

Key Terms

- **Behaviorism** – A school of psychology that studies only **observable behavior** (things we can see and measure).
- **Observable** – Something that can be seen or measured directly.
- **Consciousness** – Awareness of thoughts, feelings, and experiences inside the mind.

Explanation

Before Watson, psychologists focused on **consciousness** using a method called **introspection** (looking inside your own mind and reporting thoughts). Watson said, "No. That is too subjective. We cannot see thoughts. We can only see actions."

So he changed psychology from:

👉 "Study of the mind"

to

👉 "Study of behavior"

Example

Old psychology:

"How do you feel when you see a dog?"

Watson's psychology:

"What does the person *do* when they see a dog? Do they run? Smile? Freeze?"

2. Watson's Big Idea: Psychology = Science of Behavior

Watson defined psychology as **the scientific study of behavior**, not the study of the mind or consciousness.

Key Terms

- **Scientific** – Based on experiments, measurement, and evidence.
- **Objective** – Not based on opinion or feelings. Based on facts.

Explanation

Watson wanted psychology to be like physics or chemistry - factual, testable, and measurable.

He said:

 Don't study thoughts (we can't see them).

 Study actions (we can see and measure them).

Example

Instead of asking:

"What do you think about exams?"

Watson would observe:

- How much you study
 - How you react to failure
 - How your behavior changes after feedback
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3. Rejecting Introspection

Answer

Watson rejected **introspection** as a method because it is not scientific.

Key Terms

- **Introspection** – Looking into your own mind and describing your thoughts and feelings.
- **Method** – A way of collecting data.

Explanation

If I say:

"I feel sad today"

You cannot verify it. But if you say:

"I am crying, not talking, sitting alone"

That is observable and scientific.

So Watson said:

👉 Psychology should not use introspection.

But he allowed:

✓ **Verbal reports** after experiments.

Example

After an experiment, Watson might ask:

"What did you feel during the task?"

But the *main data* still came from behavior, not feelings.

4. Stimulus – Response (S-R)

Behavior is explained using **stimulus and response** patterns.

Key Terms

- **Stimulus (S)** – Something that happens to you.
- **Response (R)** – What you do because of it.

Explanation

Watson believed all behavior works like this:

👉 **Stimulus → Response**

Examples

- Touch fire → Pull hand back
- Hear loud noise → Jump
- Teacher shouts → Student becomes quiet

He said nothing mysterious is happening. It is all **physiological**.

- **Physiological** – Related to the body and nervous system.
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5. Thinking = Implicit Behavior

Watson said **thinking is also a kind of behavior**.

Key Terms

- **Implicit behavior** – Behavior that happens inside the body, not visible.
- **Explicit behavior** – Behavior we can see.

Explanation

When you think, you are actually doing **tiny muscle movements in your brain and speech system**. It is not magic. It is physical.

Example

When you silently solve a math problem, your brain is "acting", just like when your body moves.

6. Learning = Conditioning (Pavlov)

Watson believed learning happens through **conditioning**.

Key Terms

- **Conditioning** – Learning by association.
- **Ivan Pavlov** – Russian psychologist famous for classical conditioning.

Explanation

If two things happen together again and again, the brain connects them.

Example

Bell + Food → Dog salivates

Later: Bell alone → Dog salivates

Humans learn like this too.

7. Memory and Images = Sensory Activity

Watson said memory and images are **sensory brain activities**, not mental mysteries.

Key Terms

- **Sensory** – Related to senses like sight, sound, touch.
- **Molecular behavior** – Very small internal physical activity in the brain.

Explanation

When you remember your home, your brain is activating tiny sensory systems. Not imagination magic - just brain activity.

8. Environmentalism and Tabula Rasa

Watson believed behavior is shaped by the **environment**, not by birth.

Key Terms

- **Environmentalism** – Behavior is shaped by surroundings.
- **Tabula Rasa** – Blank slate at birth (John Locke's idea).

Explanation

A baby is born empty. Environment writes everything.

Example

A child raised in kindness → becomes kind

A child raised in violence → becomes aggressive

9. Aim of Psychology (According to Watson)

The aim is to **predict and control behavior**.

Key Terms

- **Predict** – Know what someone will do.
- **Control** – Change behavior.

Explanation

If we know:

Stimulus → Response

Then we can change behavior by changing stimulus.

1. Who was J.B. Watson?

Answer:

J.B. Watson (1878–1958) was an American psychologist and the founder of the school of **Behaviorism**. He originally studied philosophy but later turned to psychology. Watson taught at Johns Hopkins University, where he conducted experiments mainly with animals. Later, he applied psychological principles to advertising and marketing. Watson believed psychology should focus on **observable behavior**, not consciousness (awareness of thoughts and feelings).

Explanation:

Watson changed the focus of psychology. Earlier, psychologists studied thoughts and feelings (consciousness), often using **introspection** (looking inward and reporting experiences). Watson said this was unreliable. Instead, he argued that

psychology should study what can be seen and measured: behavior. He wanted psychology to be **scientific**, objective, and measurable.

Example:

Instead of asking, "How do you feel when scared?" Watson would study, "How do you physically react when you are scared?" For example, heart rate increases, muscles tense, and you might run away.

Tips:

Remember: Watson = Behaviorism = Study only observable behavior. Think **"What you can see, measure, and test."**

2. What is Behaviorism according to Watson?

Answer:

Behaviorism is a school of psychology that studies **observable behavior** in humans and animals, ignoring internal mental states such as thoughts or feelings. Watson defined psychology as **the science of behavior**, meaning psychologists should predict and control behavior through experiments rather than introspection.

Explanation:

Watson rejected the ideas of **functionalists** and **structuralists**, who studied consciousness. Behaviorism emphasizes **objective methods**, meaning experiments and observations rather than subjective reports. Watson wanted psychology to be like natural sciences, where only measurable phenomena count.

Example:

Studying how students react to a loud noise (stimulus) rather than asking how they feel inside (consciousness).

Tips:

Think: Behaviorism = **Behavior + Science**. Replace "mind" with "actions."

3. Why did Watson reject introspection?

Answer:

Watson rejected **introspection** because it is subjective and cannot be verified scientifically. He argued that psychology must focus on **observable behavior**, which can be measured and tested. Instead, he allowed **verbal reports** after experiments, which are based on controlled situations rather than spontaneous thoughts.

Explanation:

Introspection asks people to report thoughts and feelings. Watson thought this data is unreliable because everyone experiences feelings differently. But controlled verbal reports after experiments can be scientifically useful because the circumstances are controlled.

Example:

A student participates in a learning experiment. Afterward, the researcher asks, "What did you notice about your behavior during the experiment?" This report is allowed but is secondary to observing actual behavior.

Tips:

Think: "Observe first, ask later." Behavior is primary; introspection is secondary (if at all).

4. What is the Stimulus-Response (S-R) concept in Watsonian Behaviorism?

Answer:

The **Stimulus-Response (S-R) concept** says that behavior is a reaction to a stimulus. A stimulus is something external that triggers a reaction, and a response is the observable action caused by that stimulus. Watson believed all behavior can be explained using this pattern without mysterious explanations.

Explanation:

Watson used this concept to simplify behavior into measurable units. By understanding how an organism reacts to stimuli, psychologists can predict and eventually control behavior. He also emphasized that these reactions are **physiological**, not mystical.

Example:

- Touch a hot stove (stimulus) → Pull hand away (response)
- Hear a loud noise (stimulus) → Jump or cover ears (response)

Tips:

Remember: S → R. Stimulus comes first, response follows. This is the core of behaviorism.

5. How did Watson explain thinking?

Answer:

Watson explained thinking as a form of **implicit behavior**. Thinking involves internal actions of the brain, such as manipulating images or ideas. He argued that thinking is not a mysterious mental process but a **type of behavior**, similar to physical actions, only not visible.

Explanation:

Implicit behavior refers to actions that happen inside the body or brain, while explicit behavior is visible. Thinking involves small, measurable brain activities, which makes it consistent with behaviorist principles.

Example:

When you solve a math problem in your head, you are thinking. Watson would call this **thinking behavior**, because your brain and sensory system are actively working.

Tips:

Remember: Watson treats **all activity**, including thinking, as behavior. Mind = behavior.

6. How does learning occur according to Watson?

Answer:

Watson believed learning occurs through **conditioning**, following principles discovered by Ivan Pavlov. Conditioning involves forming associations between a stimulus and a response, so the organism reacts predictably when the stimulus appears.

Explanation:

Conditioning is a way to **train behavior**. Repeated pairings of stimuli and responses create predictable behaviors. Watson used this idea to explain human and animal learning scientifically.

Example:

- Pavlov's dogs: Bell (stimulus) + Food → Salivation (response)
- Later: Bell alone → Salivation
- Human example: A child hears a bell every time it's time to eat → Child feels hungry at the bell sound alone.

Tips:

Think: Conditioning = "Learned association." Pair stimulus and response repeatedly to create behavior.

7. What are memory and mental images in behaviorism?

Answer:

Watson considered memory and mental images as **sensory activities in the brain**, not mysterious mental processes. These activities can be measured as **molecular behavior**, meaning tiny physical events in the nervous system.

Explanation:

Instead of treating memory as a private mental function, Watson studied it as **physical brain activity** caused by sensory input and experiences.

Example:

Remembering your home activates tiny sensory activities in the brain, like seeing images or recalling sounds—Watson sees these as observable behaviors at a microscopic level.

Tips:

Memory = **brain activity**. Behaviorists always reduce mental events to measurable physical events.

8. What is environmentalism in Watson's behaviorism?

Answer:

Environmentalism is the idea that an organism's behavior is shaped by its **environment**. Watson believed that by controlling the environment, psychologists could predict and control behavior. This idea is similar to **John Locke's Tabula Rasa**, which states that humans are born as blank slates.

Explanation:

Watson thought genetics or innate traits were less important than learning and experience. A person's surroundings and experiences "write" their behavior over time.

Example:

- Child raised in a nurturing environment → Develops kindness
- Child raised in harsh conditions → May develop fear or aggression

Tips:

Remember: Environment shapes behavior. Think "**Nurture > Nature**" in Watsonian terms.

9. What is the main aim of psychology according to Watson?

Answer:

The main aim of psychology, according to Watson, is to **predict and control behavior**. By understanding stimulus-response patterns and the effects of the environment, psychologists can influence human and animal actions.

Explanation:

If we know what stimulus causes a particular response, we can design environments or training methods to guide behavior. This makes psychology practical and scientific.

Example:

- Training workers to follow safety rules by rewarding correct behavior

- Teaching children to read by using structured stimulus-response methods

Tips:

Think: **Predict + Control = Goal of Behaviorism.**

Long Question Answers

1. Discuss J.B. Watson's life and contributions to psychology.

Answer

Introduction:

John Broadus Watson (1878–1958) was an American psychologist, known as the **founder of Behaviorism**, a revolutionary school of psychology. He initially studied philosophy but later switched to psychology, focusing on experimental and observable behavior.

Life and Career Highlights:

- Born in 1878, United States.
- Studied **philosophy** at the University of Chicago.
- Became a professor at **Johns Hopkins University**, Baltimore, USA.
- Established **animal laboratories** for experimental research.
- Later moved to the **corporate world**, applying psychological principles to advertising and marketing.

Contributions to Psychology:

1. Founder of Behaviorism:

- Defined psychology as the **science of behavior**, not consciousness.
- Emphasized **observable, measurable actions**.

2. Rejection of Introspection:

- Argued introspection (looking inward) is unreliable.

- Promoted objective, experimental methods.

3. Stimulus-Response Theory (S-R):

- Behavior can be understood in terms of **stimulus** → **response** patterns.

4. Thinking as Behavior:

- Thought processes are a form of **implicit behavior**, not mysterious mental events.

5. Environmentalism:

- Believed behavior is shaped by the **environment** (similar to John Locke's Tabula Rasa).

6. Practical Aim of Psychology:

- Focused on **predicting and controlling behavior** for practical applications like education and industry.

Table: Watson vs Earlier Psychologists

Feature	Structuralists/Functionalists	Watsonian Behaviorism
Focus	Consciousness	Observable behavior
Method	Introspection	Experiments & observation
Aim	Understand mind	Predict and control behavior
Mental Processes	Central	Ignored or explained physiologically

Plain English Explanation

Watson basically "changed the game" in psychology. Before him, people studied thoughts and feelings, which can't be measured easily. Watson said, *let's study what we can see and test*. He experimented with animals to find predictable **stimulus** → **response** patterns. Later, he even applied these ideas to advertising to predict and influence people's choices.

Example:

- Observing how a child reacts to fear stimuli instead of asking them how they feel.
- Training workers to improve productivity using rewards and punishments.

Tip:

Remember: Watson = **Behavior, Science, Environment, Prediction, Control.**

2. Explain the basic principles of Behaviorism.

Answer

Introduction:

Behaviorism is a psychological school focused on **observable behavior**. Its principles are built on **objectivity, measurement, and environment**.

Basic Principles:

1. Psychology is the Science of Behavior

- Focus only on measurable actions.
- Consciousness and thoughts are ignored.

2. Behavior is Learned (Conditioning)

- Learning occurs through **association of stimuli and responses**.
- Follows principles of **classical conditioning** (Pavlov).

3. Stimulus-Response Relationship

- Every behavior is a reaction to a stimulus.
- Can be predicted and controlled.

4. Thinking = Implicit Behavior

- Mental activities (thinking, remembering) are forms of **internal behavior**.

5. Rejection of Introspection

- Introspection is subjective and unscientific.
- Only observed actions or controlled verbal reports are acceptable.

6. Environmental Determinism

- Behavior is shaped by **experience and surroundings**.
- Humans are born as blank slates (Tabula Rasa).

7. Goal of Psychology

- Predict and control behavior.
- Apply knowledge practically in education, industry, or therapy.

Example Table: Stimulus → Response Examples

Stimulus	Response	Notes
Touch hot stove	Withdraw hand	Physiological response
Loud sound	Jump	Reflex reaction
Teacher praise	Study harder	Learned association
Bell rings before meals	Feel hungry	Conditioning (Pavlovian)

Plain English Explanation

Behaviorism says: *watch what people do, not what they think*. It reduces psychology to patterns:

- Stimulus → Response
- Environment → Behavior

Thinking is just a hidden form of behavior. Learning happens by repeated associations, like a bell making a dog salivate. Introspection (self-reporting thoughts) is unreliable, but controlled verbal reports after experiments can be useful.

Tip:

Whenever you hear "Behaviorism," think: **Observe → Predict → Control → Apply**.

3. Describe Watson's views on learning, memory, and thinking.

Answer

Introduction:

Watson integrated physiological and behavioral perspectives into understanding learning, memory, and thinking.

Learning:

- Learning occurs through **conditioning**.
- Behavior is acquired via repeated **stimulus-response pairings**.
- Follows **Pavlov's laws of classical conditioning**.

Memory:

- Memories are **sensory activities in the brain**, not mystical processes.
- These sensory brain events can be classified as **molecular behavior**.

Thinking:

- Thinking is a form of **implicit behavior**.
- Involves manipulating images or ideas in the mind.
- Can be explained in **physiological terms**.

Examples:

1. Learning:

- Child learns to avoid fire after touching a hot stove (stimulus-response).

2. Memory:

- Recalling your home activates sensory pathways in the brain.

3. Thinking:

- Solving a mental puzzle engages brain activity (internal behavior).

Plain English Explanation

Watson thought everything mental is really **behavior**, either visible or hidden.

- Learning = forming new **behavior patterns** through experience.
- Memory = your brain's **physical reactions to past experiences**.
- Thinking = tiny internal **actions in the brain**, still behavior.

Tip:

Remember: *Behaviorism explains everything in terms of observable or measurable actions, even if the action is hidden inside the brain.*

4. What is the role of the environment according to Watson?

Answer

Introduction:

Watson believed behavior is shaped almost entirely by **environmental factors**, not innate traits.

Key Points:

1. Environmentalism:

- Organisms are affected by surroundings.
- By controlling environment, we can predict and change behavior.

2. Tabula Rasa (Blank Slate):

- Inspired by John Locke.
- Humans are born with no predetermined traits; behavior is "written" by experience.

3. Practical Implication:

- Education, parenting, and workplace behavior can be optimized by manipulating environmental stimuli.

Examples:

- Nurturing environment → Kind and cooperative child.
- Harsh environment → Aggressive or fearful behavior.
- Workplace: Rewards → Higher productivity.

Table: Environment and Behavior

Environmental Factor	Expected Behavior
Praise and rewards	Motivated, hardworking

Environmental Factor	Expected Behavior
Harsh criticism	Fearful, anxious
Structured training	Skilled and disciplined

Plain English Explanation

Watson says: *your surroundings shape you*. Genetics are less important than experience. The environment gives signals (stimuli), and you respond. By changing stimuli, we can guide behavior in desired directions.

Tip:

Remember: Behavior = Function(Environment). Think **"Life writes on your blank slate."**

5. Explain Watson's aims and practical applications of Behaviorism.

Answer

Introduction:

Behaviorism is not just theoretical; Watson emphasized practical applications.

Aims of Behaviorism:

1. Prediction of Behavior:

- Understand how organisms respond to specific stimuli.

2. Control of Behavior:

- Influence actions using environmental modifications.

3. Scientific Method:

- Use **experiments** and **objective observation** to study behavior.

Practical Applications:

• Education:

- Use conditioning to reinforce learning.

- **Industry/Workplace:**
 - Improve productivity using rewards, incentives, and behavioral analysis.
- **Parenting:**
 - Shape behavior through consistent environment and reinforcement.
- **Therapy:**
 - Treat phobias and habits using behavioral techniques (like desensitization).

Example Table: Application of Behaviorism

Field	Application	Example
Education	Reinforcement	Students rewarded for completing homework
Industry	Productivity	Incentives for meeting targets
Therapy	Behavioral modification	Gradual exposure to phobias
Parenting	Behavior shaping	Praise for polite behavior

Plain English Explanation

Behaviorism is about *using knowledge to make life better*. By understanding the S-R patterns and controlling environment, you can guide behavior in positive directions. Watson's ideas are applied in teaching, advertising, parenting, and therapy even today.

Tip:

Remember: Behaviorism = **Predict → Control → Apply → Benefit Society**

MCQs

A. Simple MCQs

1. Who is considered the founder of Behaviorism?

- a) Sigmund Freud
- b) John B. Watson

- c) B.F. Skinner
- d) Ivan Pavlov

Answer: b) John B. Watson

Explanation: Watson is recognized as the founder of Behaviorism; he emphasized studying observable behavior rather than consciousness.

2. According to Watson, psychology should study:

- a) Consciousness
- b) Thoughts and feelings
- c) Observable behavior
- d) Dreams

Answer: c) Observable behavior

Explanation: Behaviorism focuses only on measurable and visible behavior, ignoring subjective mental processes.

3. Watson rejected which method of studying psychology?

- a) Experimental method
- b) Introspection
- c) Verbal reports
- d) Observation

Answer: b) Introspection

Explanation: Introspection is subjective and unreliable; Watson favored objective experiments and observable behavior.

4. In Watson's S-R (stimulus-response) theory, the "stimulus" is:

- a) The organism's reaction
- b) An external event triggering a response
- c) Thinking in the mind
- d) The learned behavior

Answer: b) An external event triggering a response

Explanation: A stimulus is something from the environment that elicits a reaction.

5. Watson described thinking as:

- a) Consciousness
- b) Implicit behavior
- c) Imagination
- d) Introspection

Answer: b) Implicit behavior

Explanation: Thinking is a form of hidden behavior (not visible) and can be explained physiologically.

B. True/False Statements

6. Watson believed that environment plays no role in shaping behavior.

Answer: False

Explanation: Watson strongly believed in environmentalism; behavior is shaped by experience and surroundings.

7. Memory and mental images are considered by Watson as sensory activities in the brain.

Answer: True

Explanation: Watson treated memory as molecular behavior, measurable sensory activities, not mystical mental events.

8. Watson's main goal of psychology was to predict and control behavior.

Answer: True

Explanation: The ultimate aim of behaviorism is practical: predict and control behavior through S-R analysis.

9. Introspection is the primary method for behaviorists to collect data.

Answer: False

Explanation: Behaviorists reject introspection; data comes from observation, experiments, and sometimes verbal reports after controlled experiments.

10. Classical conditioning, discovered by Pavlov, influenced Watson's ideas about learning.

Answer: True

Explanation: Watson adopted Pavlov's conditioning principles to explain human and animal learning.

C. Conceptual MCQs

11. Which of the following statements best reflects Watson's view of a newborn child?

- a) Born with instinctive traits
- b) A blank slate shaped by the environment
- c) Predetermined intelligence
- d) Conscious but untrained

Answer: b) A blank slate shaped by the environment

Explanation: Watson supported **Tabula Rasa**, where the environment writes behavior on a blank slate.

12. Which of the following methods did Watson accept as a valid source of information?

- a) Free association
- b) Introspection
- c) Verbal reports after controlled experiments
- d) Dream interpretation

Answer: c) Verbal reports after controlled experiments

Explanation: Watson rejected introspection but allowed verbal reports if obtained under controlled conditions.

13. In Watsonian behaviorism, thinking is:

- a) Not part of psychology
- b) A hidden, measurable form of behavior
- c) Purely imaginary
- d) Conscious awareness

Answer: b) A hidden, measurable form of behavior

Explanation: Thinking is implicit behavior, a physiological process that can be scientifically studied.

14. Which of the following is NOT a principle of Watsonian Behaviorism?

- a) Focus on observable behavior
- b) Study of consciousness
- c) Learning through conditioning
- d) Environmental determinism

Answer: b) Study of consciousness

Explanation: Behaviorism rejects the study of consciousness as unscientific.

15. Behavior can be predicted and controlled because:

- a) All behavior is genetic
- b) Stimulus-response relationships are consistent
- c) People are conscious of all actions
- d) Introspection provides accurate data

Answer: b) Stimulus-response relationships are consistent

Explanation: S-R patterns allow psychologists to anticipate and influence behavior.

D. Situational / Application-Based MCQs

16. A child hears a bell every time food is served. Eventually, the child starts salivating at the sound of the bell alone. This illustrates:

- a) Operant conditioning

- b) Classical conditioning
- c) Observational learning
- d) Insight learning

Answer: b) Classical conditioning

Explanation: Pavlovian conditioning influenced Watson; behavior is learned via association of stimulus (bell) and response (salivation).

17. A factory uses incentives to encourage workers to increase productivity. This application reflects Watson's principle of:

- a) Environmentalism and control of behavior
- b) Thinking as implicit behavior
- c) Rejection of introspection
- d) Classical conditioning

Answer: a) Environmentalism and control of behavior

Explanation: Modifying environmental factors (like rewards) influences behavior predictably.

18. A researcher observes how students react to a sudden loud noise instead of asking them about their fear. This approach follows:

- a) Structuralism
- b) Functionalism
- c) Behaviorism
- d) Psychoanalysis

Answer: c) Behaviorism

Explanation: Behaviorism emphasizes **observable behavior**, not self-reported feelings.

19. A therapist gradually exposes a patient to a fear stimulus (like a dog) in a controlled setting. This technique aligns with Watson's principles because:

- a) It uses introspection to understand fear

- b) Behavior is studied and modified through environmental control
- c) It relies on unconscious mind
- d) Memory is not considered

Answer: b) Behavior is studied and modified through environmental control

Explanation: Gradual exposure is behavioral modification, consistent with stimulus-response and environmentalism.

20. During an experiment, a participant silently solves a mental puzzle. Watson would classify this as:

- a) Conscious introspection
- b) Explicit behavior
- c) Implicit behavior
- d) Intuition

Answer: c) Implicit behavior

Explanation: Internal thought processes are forms of hidden behavior, measurable as physiological activity.

Cheat Sheet (Lesson 19)

1. Key Terms and Definitions

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook
Behaviorism	School of psychology studying observable behavior only	Observing a child's reaction to fear	Think: "Behavior = Science = Observe"
Stimulus (S)	An external event that triggers a response	Touching fire → Withdraw hand	S = Something that triggers
Response (R)	The action caused by a stimulus	Pulling hand back from stove	R = Reaction/action
Stimulus-Response (S-R)	Basic unit of behavior; stimulus leads to	Loud noise → Jump	"S → R = Predictable"

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook
	response		Behavior"
Introspection	Looking inward at your own thoughts/feelings	Reporting emotions while thinking	Behaviorists ❌ introspection
Implicit Behavior	Hidden/internal behavior like thinking	Solving a math problem in your mind	Think = internal behavior
Explicit Behavior	Observable actions	Running, writing, smiling	Behavior you can see
Conditioning	Learning via association	Bell + Food → Dog salivates	C = Connect stimuli & response
Classical Conditioning	Learning by associating neutral stimulus with natural response	Pavlov's dogs	Pavlov + Watson = S-R learning
Environmentalism	Behavior is shaped by surroundings	Nurturing environment → Kind child	Life writes on blank slate
Tabula Rasa	"Blank slate" at birth (Locke)	Baby learns kindness from environment	T-R = Blank mind written on
Molecular Behavior	Tiny sensory/brain activity representing memory	Remembering home images	Brain = tiny actions = memory
Prediction & Control	Goal of behaviorism: anticipate and influence behavior	Using rewards to encourage learning	Predict → Control → Apply

2. Key People

Name	Contribution	Keyword/Hook
John B. Watson (1878–1958)	Founder of Behaviorism; psychology = science of behavior	Watson = Behaviorist
Ivan Pavlov	Classical conditioning; learning via stimulus-response	Pavlov's dogs = association

3. Small Examples to Remember

- **S-R Example:** Touch hot stove → Withdraw hand
 - **Learning/Conditioning:** Bell + Food → Dog salivates → Bell alone → Dog salivates
 - **Thinking:** Solving puzzle silently = implicit behavior
 - **Environmentalism:** Child raised with praise → Polite behavior
 - **Practical application:** Factory incentives → Increased productivity
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4. Memory Hooks / Mnemonics

1. **S → R → P:** Stimulus → Response → Predict (Behaviorism predicts and controls behavior)
 2. **TABULA:** Thought = implicit, Actions = explicit, Behavior only, Use environment, Learn via conditioning, Apply practically
 3. **Observe, Predict, Control (OPC):** Key aim of Behaviorism
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5. Tables for Quick Revision

A. Behaviorism vs Other Schools

Feature	Structuralism	Functionalism	Behaviorism
Focus	Consciousness	Function of mind	Observable behavior
Method	Introspection	Observation & experiment	Experiment + observation
Aim	Understand mind	Adaptation	Predict & control behavior
Thinking	Studied	Studied	Implicit behavior
Memory	Mind-based	Function	Sensory/molecular activity

B. Environmentalism Examples

Environment	Likely Behavior Outcome
Nurturing & loving	Kind, cooperative child
Harsh, violent	Aggressive, fearful behavior
Reward-based school	Motivated, disciplined students
Structured workplace	Productive employees

C. S-R Quick Examples

Stimulus	Response	Notes
Touch hot stove	Withdraw hand	Reflex, physiological
Loud sound	Jump	Reflex, measurable
Bell before meals	Salivation	Conditioning
Praise for homework	Study more	Environmental influence

✔ Memory Trick Summary:

"OPC + TABULA"

- **O**bserve → **P**redict → **C**ontrol
- **T**hought = implicit, **A**ctions = explicit, **B**ehavior only, **U**se environment, **L**earn via conditioning, **A**pply practically